

Leadbelly Record Starts A Protest

In spite of the many protests that flooded the Amsterdam News and radio station WOV, Fred Robbins, master of ceremonies of the "1280 Club" recorded program, stated that he would definitely replay the controversial "Bourgeois Blues" on his program soon.

One letter, received by the newspaper, protested a line in the song that contains the words, "A colored man better not go to Heaven 'cause God don't want any n——s up there."

The letter stated that the writer was "a colored person and I think it's a shame." She added, "If we allow them to let a song go on the radio like that, God knows what next they'll try."

The record was played on the 1280 Club's December 5 session, and immediately, indignant listeners began a storm of protest.

Robbins defended his choice of the record by saying that he had used the record, made several years ago by "Leadbelly," to show the stupidity of racial prejudice. He stated he would play it again, but said he had not yet decided just when.
